

The Big Picture

You are building **HireSphere** (originally conceptualized as Career Compass/PlaceOS), a comprehensive Placement Preparation Platform designed to help college students track their DSA progress, resumes, mock interviews, and company roadmaps, while giving Placement Coordinators a dashboard to manage it all.

Phase 1 Completed: The Architecture

You just finished **Week 1: The Foundation**, which is notorious for being the hardest part of software development. You successfully built a **Monorepo**—a single project folder that houses both your frontend and backend so they can communicate seamlessly.

Here are the specific tools you used and what you did with them:

1. The Frontend (What the user sees)

- **React:** The core JavaScript library you used to build the interactive user interface.
- **Vite:** The lightning-fast build tool you used to bootstrap your React app and run your local development server (localhost:5173).
- **Tailwind CSS:** The styling framework you used to instantly design that beautiful, dark-themed "College Campus Vibe" dashboard without writing clunky CSS files.

2. The Backend (The brain of the app)

- **Node.js & Express:** The server environment and framework you used to build your backend API listening on localhost:5000.
- **TypeScript:** You built your server using strongly-typed JavaScript to catch bugs before they happen.
- **CORS (Cross-Origin Resource Sharing):** The security middleware you configured to allow your Vite frontend to securely ask your Express backend for data.

3. The Database (Where data lives forever)

- **Neon PostgreSQL:** The modern, serverless cloud database you provisioned to permanently store your application's data.
- **dotenv (.env):** The security tool you used to hide your secret database passwords so they don't get leaked on the internet.
- **Drizzle ORM:** The tool we configured on the backend to eventually manage our SQL database tables.

4. DevOps & Pipeline (How code is managed)

- **Git & GitHub:** You initialized version control, created a repository, set up branch protection rules (like main), and successfully pushed your feature/frontend-connection branch to the cloud.